



Shalom Zone Guide for Young Adults

Goal: To create a quiet/calm down space in your home for you to use to help regulate strong emotions in a healthy way.

Target Audience: Young Adults ages 18+

Time: Approximately 1 hour to create or more if you want to be creative

Medium: @Home project

Note: With all that is going on in the lives of young adults, it is very helpful to have a relaxation space where you are able to reduce overwhelming feelings. By reducing the sensory overload of the day, like noise, social interactions, work, visual input, and auditory stimulation, you can reduce the emotional overload that can come along with typical stressors of the day.

What is a Shalom Zone?

The Shalom Zone is a safe space for you to go when you need help self-regulating or calming your body and emotions. It is meant to be a place for you to relax, recharge or even release your pent-up anger or frustration.

Picking The Right Space For The Shalom Zone

Try to pick one space in your house or apartment for the Shalom Zone area so that you know exactly where to go when you need it.

It should be away from distractions and can be really anywhere you want: in your bedroom, in the basement, under the stairs, in a closet, in a corner of a room — wherever you think you will be the most comfortable!

When To Use The Shalom Zone

The Shalom Zone space should feel welcoming and inviting. Use the calm Shalom Zone right after school/work, or before bed to help decompress after a long day. It's a great way to avoid having an attitude or showing anger towards others. Retreating to a calm down space is perfect for when you are feeling angry, frustrated, anxious, or overwhelmed.

Watch your body and behaviour for signs that you might be overwhelmed and need a break.

What To Include In Your Shalom Zone

- Here are some examples of items to consider including in your Shalom Zone: ● Printable Signs to Hang:
 - ○ A [“My Shalom Zone”](#) sign that your child designs and can hang in their space
 - ○ Emotional Regulation Chart - [What Zone Am I In?](#)
 - ○ [10 Steps to Calm Down](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Exercises](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Motivational Phrases](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Emotions](#)
- A comfy place to sit like a bean bag chair, some pillows, or big chair
- A journal to document your journey or get out your emotions
- A sketchbook to express your feelings or relax through art
- Lego, playdough/clay, or some fun toy that you may still like to play with
- [Fidget toys to spin, twist and manipulate](#)
- Art supplies and/or sticker books
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Puzzles
- [One Person card games](#)
- Noise-reducing headphones to block out sounds that are overwhelming
- [Chewy jewelry and toys](#)
- Stress balls to squeeze or [make your own](#)
- [Yoga poses for relaxation](#)
- [Resistance Bands](#)
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Knitting supplies
- Audio books
- A favourite stuffed animal to hug
- Something visual like a kaleidoscope, lava lamp, little lights or [make your own!](#)
- Engaging one-person activities like activity books, individual board games, crosswords, sudoku, or drawing books.